

Modern carving and engraving

Carving a gem is a step on from faceting it – it involves cutting it into a three-dimensional shape. Gems can also be engraved by incising decorative lines. The first task is to select a rough gem that is of high quality and large enough to withstand the loss of material during carving. Carved gems can be sculptures in their own right or turned into jewellery.



Rock crystal flacon

This amethyst and gold stopper was made by Tom Munsteiner, son of Bernd Munsteiner (see p.243).



Sign sculpture

Gem artist Tom Munsteiner also created this bold rock crystal sculpture.



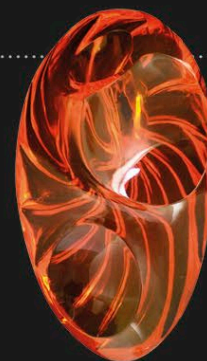
Summer Snow earrings

These carved earrings by Alice Cicolini consist of gold, pavé diamonds, amethyst, rock crystal, and rose quartz.



Tourmaline ring

This Munsteiner ring is based around a carved 9.11-carat tourmaline. It is set in yellow gold.



Vortex Mexican opal

This gem sculpture by Michael Dyber is a 299.45-carat opal in a flowing, free-form cut.